

Difference Between the Internet and an Intranet

The **Internet** and an **intranet** are both networks used to share information, but they differ in who can access them and what they are used for.

Feature	Internet	Intranet
Meaning	A worldwide public network connecting millions of devices.	A private network used inside an organization such as a college or company.
Access	Anyone with an internet connection can use it.	Only authorized users can access it.
Users	General public worldwide.	Students, teachers, employees, or organization members.
Purpose	Access public websites, social media, email, videos, and online services.	Share internal notices, study materials, attendance records, files, and private resources.
Example	Google, YouTube, Instagram, Wikipedia	College student portal, internal library system, staff portal

Suppose I am at my college and connect my laptop or smartphone to the **college Wi Fi**.

Internet example: I open a web browser and visit YouTube, Google, or Instagram. My request travels from the college Wi Fi network through the Internet Service Provider (ISP) to servers outside the college. This is the **Internet** because I am accessing public services available worldwide.

Intranet example: My college may have a private student portal where students can check attendance, download internal notes, view exam notices, or access laboratory files. If this portal is available only to college students and staff using a login or the college network, it is an **intranet**.